

Gift Acceptance Policy



How gifts are received, reviewed, accepted, declined, and honored, under the powers of Bylaws Section 10.6.

Until federal tax exemption is recognized: contributions are received through the corporation's fiscal sponsor, the Virtual World Society, and every solicitation states so, as Resolution 11 requires. Donor acknowledgments issue under the sponsorship arrangement. This provision ceases to apply when federal recognition is received.

ACCEPTED WITHOUT SPECIAL REVIEW

Unrestricted gifts of cash by check or electronic payment, and in-kind goods or services the corporation can use directly in its programs, logged on receipt and reported in the Treasurer's Report.

ACCEPTED ONLY AFTER REVIEW

The Treasurer and Chair review the following before acceptance, taking board direction where significant:

- Restricted gifts: the restriction must be one the corporation can honor and track.
- Gifts with naming, recognition, publicity, or reporting conditions.
- Securities, cryptocurrency, real property, vehicles, or intellectual property.
- Gifts from any party in an active transaction or dispute with the corporation, or from a covered person under the Conflict of Interest Policy.
- Foreign-source gifts, reviewed for sanctions, reporting, and source before acceptance.
- Any gift that carries ongoing cost, liability, or obligation beyond the gift itself.

DECLINING

The corporation may decline, return, or restrict any gift that is inconsistent with its purposes, creates undue private benefit, imposes inappropriate control over its programs or governance, or creates unacceptable risk. Declining a gift requires no explanation beyond this policy.

HONORING RESTRICTIONS

Donor-restricted funds are used only as restricted, tracked separately, and reported at each board meeting in the Treasurer's Report. A restriction the corporation can no longer honor is resolved with the donor, or as the law provides.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT AND RECORD

Every gift is logged on receipt. Written acknowledgment issues for any gift of \$250 or more, and for any gift where the donor requests one; while the fiscal sponsorship is in effect, acknowledgments issue under the sponsorship arrangement. Gift records are retained under the Document Retention and Destruction Policy.

ADOPTION

Adopted as board policy by resolution of the Board of Directors on _____,
recorded in the minutes; reviewed annually with the policy review.